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Packaging is now a regulated product: the PPWR file EU buyers will ask for

Since 12 August 2026 the packaging around your goods needs its own declaration, documentation and substance evidence.

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October 2026

Executive summary

1. The EU Packaging and Packaging Waste Regulation, Regulation (EU) 2025/40, has applied since 12 August 2026. Packaging placed on the EU market must now come with an EU declaration of conformity backed by technical documentation, and food-contact packaging must respect new limits on PFAS.
2. For Turkish exporters this reaches further than the packaging industry. Any company that ships goods into the EU in boxes, films, pallet wraps or retail packs is placing packaging on the market, and its EU customers are starting to ask who holds the file.
3. The larger design obligations, such as recyclability grades, minimum recycled content and empty-space limits, arrive from 2028 and 2030. The decisions that make them affordable, about materials, formats and suppliers, are being taken now.

What has changed

The PPWR entered into force on 11 February 2025 and has applied since 12 August 2026. Unlike the directive it replaces, it is a regulation: the same requirements apply directly in every member state, with conformity assessment, technical documentation and an EU declaration of conformity for packaging.

Several requirements apply from the start. Packaging must keep substances of concern within the regulation’s limits. Food-contact packaging may not exceed 25 parts per billion for any single PFAS, 250 parts per billion for the sum of targeted PFAS, or 50 parts per million for total PFAS. A draft Commission notice published in 2026 recommends testing total fluorine first and moving to targeted analysis only where needed.

The regulation distinguishes roles. The manufacturer, usually whoever has packaging made or sold under its name, is responsible for conformity and the declaration. The producer, the party that first makes packaging available in a member state, must register in that country’s extended producer responsibility scheme and report volumes. A company outside the EU may need an authorised representative.

Later milestones follow: harmonised labelling of material composition from 12 August 2028, design-for-recycling criteria and the 50 per cent empty-space ratio from 2030, and minimum recycled content in plastic packaging from 2030. Packaging placed on the market before 12 August 2026 may remain on the market.

The decision behind the requirement

For an exporter the immediate question is who holds the file for each packaging format: you, your packaging supplier or your EU customer. Where the answer is unclear, EU buyers will push the work upstream, often through supplier questionnaires that arrive without much explanation.

The second question is design. Every format you use today has a cost, a material and a supplier. Formats that will struggle with the 2030 recyclability and empty-space rules are cheaper to change on your own schedule than under a buyer's deadline.

Packaging data also overlaps with other demands: extended producer responsibility fees in each country, PFAS restrictions under chemicals law, and product passports for some sectors. Building one clean record of formats, materials, weights and suppliers serves all of them.

Five common misreadings

"We are not a packaging company, so the PPWR does not apply to us." It applies to the packaging around the goods you ship, not only to companies that make packaging.

"Our packaging supplier is responsible." The supplier may be the manufacturer of the packaging, but if it is sold under your name, or you first make it available in a member state, some obligations fall on you.

"The rules start in 2030." The declaration, documentation, substance limits and food-contact PFAS limits have applied since 12 August 2026. The 2030 dates concern design.

"A PFAS-free claim from the supplier is enough." The technical documentation should contain evidence, and a stepwise testing approach is recommended until harmonised methods exist.

"Labels can wait." Harmonised material labels apply from August 2028, and changing artwork across many formats takes longer than most teams expect.

Questions for the leadership team

1. How many packaging formats do we ship into the EU, and who is the manufacturer of each?
2. In which member states are we, or our customers, the producer for extended producer responsibility?
3. Do we have supplier declarations for substances of concern, and test evidence where risk is high?
4. Which formats are food-contact packaging subject to the PFAS limits?
5. Which formats will struggle with recyclability grades or empty-space limits from 2030?
6. Have EU customers asked us for declarations of conformity or packaging data?
7. Do we need an authorised representative in any member state?
8. Who owns packaging compliance in our business today?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a packaging map for the formats that carry most of your EU volume. It should show who holds each file, which evidence is missing, which formats are at risk from the 2030 design rules, and what to say to EU customers who are asking.

Ganrich Advisory runs this as a focused review with your operations, purchasing and export teams, and brings in accredited laboratories or legal counsel where testing or formal advice is needed. We share the working method in a conversation rather than in print, because it depends on the product range.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 23–24 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: Regulation (EU) 2025/40 on packaging and packaging waste: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2025/40/oj · European Commission, Packaging waste: environment.ec.europa.eu/topics/waste-and-recycling/packaging-waste_en · European Commission, draft notice on the interpretation of Regulation (EU) 2025/40, C(2026) 2151

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